

***Your real
challenges.***



Topic challenge

Track	Focus	Example Challenge Areas
 Future of Work and International Talent	Help international students and skilled migrants access meaningful career opportunities, while helping Australian employers identify, develop and retain diverse talent.	• Skills and job matching, • Australian career pathways, • Credential recognition, • Workforce planning, • Inclusive recruitment, • Employee onboarding and retention



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The Problem

1. Australia continues to attract global talent

680,582

International Student in Australia from Jan-May 2026

Source: Australian Government Department of Education (2026).

 **+2%**

Higher Education enrolments compared to Jan-May 2025

 **-6.9%**

Overall international students vs Jan-May 2025

2. Employer expectations are changing

69%

of Australian employer report difficulty finding skilled talent.

(ManpowerGroup, 2024)

92%

of technology executives believe AI capability will become an essential workforce skill within the next five years.

(KPMG Global Tech Report, 2026)



THE REAL CHALLENGE

Australia is not lacking talent
It is facing a growing gap between graduate capability and workforce expectations in an AI-enabled economy

Key Insights

680,582 international students studied in Australia between January and May 2026, while Higher Education enrolments continued to grow (+2% year-on-year). This reflects Australia's continued ability to attract highly educated international talent. (Australian Government Department of Education, 2026).

While 69% of Australian employers report difficulty finding skilled talent, 92% of technology executives believe AI capability will become an essential workforce skill within the next five years. This signals that employers are increasingly seeking graduates who can combine technical expertise with AI literacy and digital capability. (ManpowerGroup, 2024; KPMG, 2026).

Australian employers also face difficulties identifying transferable skills, evaluating international experience and connecting with suitably qualified candidates despite ongoing workforce shortages.



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The challenge is no longer attracting talent.
It is helping talent succeed.

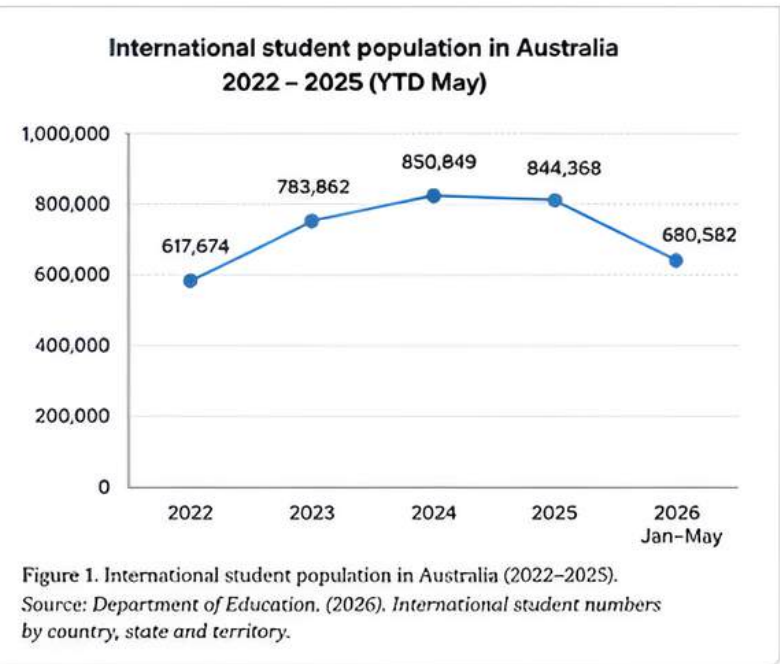
Challenge Tracks

TRACK 1 - Future of Work and International Talent

CHALLENGE QUESTION

How might we use AI, data and digital technology to help international students and skilled migrants access meaningful career opportunities, while helping Australian employers identify, develop and retain diverse talent?

CONTEXT



Australia continues to attract a growing international talent pool through its higher education system and skilled migration programs.

Between 2022 and 2024, the number of international students increased by approximately 38%, reaching more than 850,000 students nationwide.

While this growth contributes significantly to Australia's economy and workforce, it also increases the need for more effective pathways that help international talent transition successfully into employment.

THE PROBLEM



International talent face barriers

- Understanding local recruitment processes
- Translating overseas qualifications
- Building professional networks
- Gaining relevant Australian experience



Employers face challenges

- Identifying transferable skills
- Evaluating international experience
- Connecting with suitable candidates
- Retaining diverse talent



These issues create a disconnect between available talent and labour market demand.



YOUR CHALLENGE

Design an AI powered solution that improves employment outcomes for international talent while helping Australian organisations better identify, develop and retain skilled people.

Your solution should demonstrate clear value for users, be technically feasible and address a genuine workforce challenge in Australia

CHALLENGE AREAS

Participants may choose to focus on one or more of the following areas.



Career
Navigation



Skills Recognition
& Job Matching



Employability &
Career Readiness



Employer Recruitment
& Workforce Planning

EXAMPLE SOLUTION DIRECTIONS



AI Career Advisor

Personalised guidance on career pathways, roles and next steps.



Skills Translation Platform

Translate overseas skills and experience into Australian standards.



AI Employability Coach

Provide feedback on applications, interviews and job readiness.



Employer Matching Platform

Match talent with employers based on skills, potential and culture fit.



Workforce Analytics Dashboard

Real-time insights on talent pipelines, skills gaps and demand trends.



AI Onboarding Assistant

Support smoother onboarding and integration for international hires.



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Challenge Guidelines

Challenge Expectations

Your team does not need to solve every part of the challenge. You should identify **one clear problem, one main target user** and a **realistic solution** that can be developed within the hackathon.

Strong submissions will demonstrate:

- A clearly defined user problem.
- Evidence that the problem is important.
- A focused and realistic solution.
- A working prototype or convincing proof of concept.
- A clear explanation of how the technology works.
- Consideration of implementation, privacy, fairness and accessibility.
- A measurable benefit for users, organisations or communities

Effective hackathon challenge briefs usually connect a broad issue with a specific user, local context, practical constraints and supporting resources. The humanitarian challenge uses individual personas and a clear problem scenario to guide participants. The ASEF challenge examples similarly move from a broad theme to a clearly defined local problem, target population and intended impact.

Teams should avoid relying on:

- Data that would not realistically be available.
- Unreasonable budgets.
- Technology that cannot be explained.
- Fully automated high-impact decisions without human review.

What Teams Can Build

Your solution may take the form of:

- An AI agent or assistant
- A web or mobile application
- A data analytics dashboard
- A recommendation or matching system
- An automation tool
- A predictive analytics solution
- A digital service or platform
- A working prototype supported by a clear implementation plan

Teams are encouraged to use AI, data and digital tools where they add genuine value. Using AI for the sake of including AI will not result in a higher score. Teams should clearly explain why the selected technology is appropriate for the problem.

Key Constraints

All teams should consider the following requirements.

Responsible use of AI and data

- Privacy and data protection
- Bias and fairness
- Transparency
- Security
- Appropriate human oversight
- Responsible use of personal and employment information

Accessibility and inclusion

Solutions should be usable by people with different:

- Cultural and language backgrounds
- Levels of digital confidence
- Education and professional experience
- Accessibility requirements

Practical implementation

Solutions should be realistic for an Australian employer, university, training provider or community organisation to implement.

SUBMISSION & FINAL DELIVERABLES



01

SUBMISSION PACKAGE

Each team must submit:



Pitch Deck
PDF format



GitHub Repository
Public link



3-Minute Demo Video
YouTube link



File naming:
Team Name_File Type
(Pitch/Video/Deck/...)



Please ensure all links are accessible and the GitHub repository is set to **Public**.



02

SUBMISSION REPRESENTATIVE



Only 1 representative
needs to submit

on behalf of the team.

They can update the team information if needed.



03

SUBMISSION CHANNEL



To:
business.development
@mentor-me.com.au



CC:
linh.nguyen@mentor
plus.com.au



Subject:
Futura Remix 2026 –
[Team Name] Submission



04

FINAL DEADLINE



DAY 3

11:30 AM (GMT+7)

2:30 PM (AEST)

HARD CUTOFF

All required materials
must be submitted
before the deadline.



SUBMIT COMPLETE. SUBMIT ON TIME. BUILD WITH PROOF.

20% commitment. 80% Day 03.

Number	CATEGORY	WEIGHT	WHAT JUDGES OBSERVE
1	Day 1-2 be present	20%	Attended Day 1-2 · joined a team · engaged · roles assigned + Camera on + Feedback Form
2	Problem and User Understanding	12%	Clearly defines the problem and target users Shows evidence of real user needs or pain points Demonstrates strong understanding of the problem context
3	Solution Quality and Innovation	12%	Solution directly addresses the identified problem Shows creativity or a meaningful point of difference Uses AI in a relevant and purposeful way
4	Prototype and Technical Execution	28%	Delivers a functional and convincing prototype Demonstrates strong technical implementation and integration Uses vibe coding and AI tools effectively to build the solution
5	Evaluation, Limitations and Future Development	16%	Critically evaluates the current solution and its limitations Identifies key risks, trade-offs or areas for improvement Provides realistic and thoughtful next steps for future development
6	Pitch and Live Demonstration	8%	Communicates the problem and solution clearly Provides a smooth and convincing live demonstration Responds confidently and effectively to judges' questions
7	Creativity (Video / Pitch Presentation)	4%	Creative storytelling, visual style or production quality that makes the pitch video memorable Effective use of marketing/branding sensibility (music, editing, pacing) Leaves a strong impression beyond just information delivery

THANK YOU

